

The Lure in the Mist

Tuesday, 14 July 2026

Played: 2026-07-14 (recorded 8:37 PM–10:53 PM ET) · **Table:** Matt (DM), Robert (Thomas A. Invictus), Anthony (Morgash the Gravemaker), Tom (Gren Greenmantle), Drew (Jetten Elisedil)
In-game: day two morning → day three morning — east off the Trade Way, through the Misty Forest (blight ambush at the clearing, the wisp-lure to the ettercap temple), long rest in the cleansed shrine, and first sight of Greenrest. **Shards held: 0. Party levels to 4** (milestone: reached Greenrest).

Into the Misty Forest

Morning of day two at the cave. Thomas pressed Gren about Greenrest — the forest gnome grew up in these woods and has never heard of it (History 14: Misty Forest settlements are small, secluded, private; a village unknown even to locals wouldn't be strange, though traders might know it). Morgash hauled the wrecked cart off the road before leaving — tidy orc. Then east, off the map's last safe line.

The forest was Gren's childhood and Jetten's element: trails a little more than deer trails, mist everywhere, small animals watching. Jetten scouted ahead; the party kept 30-foot spacing. **The running joke of the day: Morgash out-navigated everybody.** Repeated group Survival checks had the ranger (11) and the native gnome (11, 15-adv, later a 3-adv) wandering while the Baldur's-Gate city orc rolled **23** and then **21**, repeatedly pointing Jetten the right direction. DM: "I'm not sure why Morgash is so much better than everyone else at navigating... maybe he's careful because this is the first time he's been in something like this." By his 23 they knew they were halfway through.

The Clearing — Blight Ambush

Around midday (~4 hours of march) the party stopped to rest in a clearing. The birdsong stopped; the mist went still. Jetten (Survival 17) and Gren (21) both read it in time — **neither was surprised** when five blights pulled themselves out of the treeline and ringed the camp: three twig blights, two vine blights.

- **Jetten** (initiative 24, advantage via Dread Ambusher) killed a **vine blight before it ever acted** — longbow 11 + Dreadful Strike 9 psychic.
- **Morgash** opened his account by halving a twig blight in one slice (12+1), then discovered his new **Adrenaline Rush** (bonus-action Dash + 2 temp HP) and used it to cross the clearing and bottle up the far side. Later a 23-to-hit killed a second twig (11+1). Graze chipped 3 through his one miss.

- **Thomas** worked First Light's **Sap** mastery all fight — the sapped vine blight missed him "terribly" at disadvantage. His STR save 17 shrugged the other vine's **Entangle** off: "the vines snap, and you laugh." *"You will never be able to catch me."* His **crit** (25 → 10) killed the last twig blight.
- **Gren** missed his first Sorcerous Burst (9 — he'd mis-clicked Innate Sorcery and refunded it), then hit 24 and named the damage **fire** — vulnerability doubled it on the woody thing (his 1d8 chained/exploded to boot).
- Jetten's 25 → 10 killed the entangling vine blight (its concentration spell died with it); the ring collapsed. Nobody took a scratch — every blight attack roll (9, 16, 11, 19, 8-dis) missed AC.

Post-mortem: Gren — *"These are a corruption of life itself. Perhaps there's more corruption... we need to find its source."* Thomas burned his **Channel Divinity (Divine Sense)**: no fey, fiends, or undead within 60 ft. His Arcana 12 got the basics (blights sprout from a source of evil, lurk-and-ambush); Jetten confirmed the clearing was a perfect ambush site; Morgash (Survival 14) tried to backtrail them without much to show.

The Light in the Mist

Hours more east. Late afternoon the mist gave way to bare wet rock and a low gray cliff split by a cleft taller than a man — and a single small light, round and warm as a candle, casting **no glow and no shadow**, drifting toward them and back, "quicker and insistent, the way a hand beckons someone who is running out of time... almost pleading." It slipped into the cave.

Gren: *"One of our fairy friends may be in distress — we should investigate."* Jetten: *"I don't think this is Greenrest, but let's take a quick look."* Into the cave: cold air over the ankles, wet stone, something sweetly rotten. Gren dropped Light (on Thomas, the party's blind spot, again); Jetten crept ahead (Stealth 15) — and spotted the ambush waiting in the webs before it sprang. *"How delightful. It was a trap, guys."* The dancing light winked out.

The Web-Halls

A wave fight in the dark of a ruined, web-strung hall — and the session's best worst roll: **Morgash's initiative: a natural 1** (total 1), minutes after his all-day navigation clinic. Jetten: *"You were so great leading us through the woods... what did you roll, like a zero for initiative?"*

Round one: Jetten went in blades-first on the ettercap — shortsword 20 → 5 (Vex) + scimitar 18 → 5 (Nick). Thomas **Blessed** all three martials (it mattered all night — concentration saves and scorching rays kept landing on the d4). The ettercap clawed Jetten (4) and let out a long wail — **calling the brood**. Gren answered with **Innate Sorcery + Scorching Ray**: 26 (crit, 15), 24 through half cover (3), 20 (6) — first ettercap burnt to a crisp. And Morgash made his late turn count: reading the ettercap's nervous glances at a closed door, he **dashed across the hall and blocked the door** before anything could come through it.

Then the waves: a broodling webbed Thomas (DEX 8 — restrained); reinforcements poured in on round two (a second adult at initiative 21, more broodlings — one at 20); the DM introduced **lair actions** — and on the lair's beat the dancing light returned, "and this time it looks very hostile": a **will-o'-wisp**, initiative 24. Jetten: *"It's like a very British Isles encounter here."*

Highlights, in rough order:

- Jetten's 24 → 7 killed the first broodling; Thomas hacked himself free of the web (9 slashing to the strand) after a turn at speed 0.
- **The Broodmother** burst through the door Morgash was holding: bite 18 → 10+3 **poison** (condition applied), claw 23 → 5. Morgash — poisoned, disadvantaged, surrounded — turned a 9-miss into a hit with **Precision Attack** (+7) for 14: "the patented double back swing."
- **Keoghtom's Ointment, dose one** (10 HP, cures poison — back to full): "Excellent play." **Action Surge** followed; the second Precision die came up 1 and the swing stayed a miss (Graze 3 anyway).
- The wisp **shocked Gren from invisibility** (advantage 20 → 9 lightning) and vanished again; its first attack (7) had missed Jetten. Gren switched to **Subtle Spell + Magic Missile** and turned the unerring darts **on the Broodmother** (the wisp never gave him a target).
- Jetten peppered the Broodmother (26 → 7 + Dreadful Strike 11 psychic; later 19 → 8 + 4) and put a doubled **Healing Word** (2d4+3 = 11) on himself after the Broodmother's second bite cycle re-poisoned Morgash (bite 20 → 6+3).
- Thomas missed the wisp (his planned Divine Smite died with the 13), spent **Lay on Hands** twice (10 on Morgash, 5 on Gren), then **crit a broodling flat out of existence** (25 → 16). Jetten: *"We're going to call you Thomas the Silent."*
- **Morgash, Keoghtom's dose two** (14, cures the second poison). Gren's **Spellfire Burst** rode his sorcery points for temp-HP gifts (7, then 6 — to Morgash).
- **Gren's Magic Missile volley (3+5+5) dropped the Ettercap Broodmother.** "With that final blast of magic missiles, the broodmother falls."
- The will-o'-wisp **vanished and never came back** — fled, not slain. Gren: *"We're going to seek vengeance on that will-o'-wisp. It tricked us — it, and all of its kind, in the future."*

The Ruined Fey Temple

The fight's arena revealed itself: an ancient ruined **temple**, webbed and bone-strewn — the ettercaps' feeding hall. Thomas's Arcana 7 earned the DM's finest ruling: "You don't know shit about will-o'-wisps." But his **Religion 25** (with Gren's Guidance d4) read the stones true: the statues are a shrine to **fey-like figures — elves, most likely**; the bowls are alms bowls that once held water; elven temples run small, so this is most of it. **Gren quietly poured a little water into each empty bowl.** Jetten's Perception 15 upstairs: cold stone, etchings worn past reading, no sentient tenant in a very long time.

Gren burned out the webs with fire. The bones were picked clean (Medicine 12/5 — nothing more to learn). Golden mushrooms in the hall: "barely edible, horrible tasting" — Jetten: *"Let's not eat the mushrooms, guys."* Down the south passage: a **dead fey creature — possibly an elf — months dead, a dagger still on the body**, beside the ettercaps' victim-loot.

Loot — and Goldthorn

From the pile (Item Piles split, ~10:01 PM):

- **Jetten — Gilded Scimitar + Cloak of Elvenkind** ("you also hide, right").
- **Thomas — Lantern of Revealing + A Dose of Greenrest Tonic.**
- **Morgash — Potion of Healing.**
- **67 gp each** (× 4).

The scimitar *wanted to speak to Jetten* — the same pull Thomas felt from First Light. The DM identified it: **Goldthorn** — "lost with its bearer to the webs of a hidden temple in the Misty Forest and dormant ever since... waiting on a worthy hand. Its fey magic stirs once between dawns: a bloom of clinging faerie light that lets nothing hide in shadow." (**Faerie Fire 1/day.**) Jetten attuned overnight. ("So cool. You're such an edge lord.")

The tonic is the quiet bombshell of the night — **the village's name found them before the village did**. A stoppered clay vial of bitter green cordial, found among the web-wrapped effects of a traveller who never left the temple; the label, in a tidy, careful hand, reads only: *"One swallow, seventh-day, as ever. — Selma."* Thomas also spoke aloud what they learned of it: *"Whoever drinks the swallow sleeps utterly, without dreams, for the next seven nights. No apothecary could name any other virtue... nor say why anyone would brew such a thing."* The Lantern of Revealing got lit immediately to hunt the wisp — gone.

Long rest in the cleansed temple: Jetten took his reverie near the entrance on watch, and recovered half his spent arrows (+4).

First Sight of Greenrest

Two hours east on day three the trees thinned, the trail climbed one last rise, "and the forest lets you go." Below, cradled in green meadows under a cloudless sky: slate roofs snug around a square, straight chimney smoke, orchards and hedged fields, birdsong, cut hay, woodsmoke. To the right, an **old stone watchtower** on the height (~300 yards), a worn path spilling from its foot. And dead center in all that green, **a single great tree gone gray and sickly — "the one wrong note in an otherwise perfect song."** The DM shared the Greenrest player handout.

Where things stand

- **Level 4 for all four PCs** (milestone: reaching Greenrest). Players' homework before next session: level up in Foundry — the big choice is a **feat**.
 - Shards held: o. Next session opens with the village (and optionally the watchtower first), and the choice of which of the **four shards of the Broken Heart** to hunt.
 - The will-o'-wisp escaped. The blight-source thread is live (Gren wants the source found).
 - **Next session: Tuesday 2026-08-11, 8 PM ET** (Robert calendar-confirmed). Two players are abroad until 2026-08-10. DM emails before the 11th.
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Recorded at the table — transcribed & chronicled by the party scribe.